

Ludovic BOCKEN, PHD (c)



INNOVATOR, AI SPECIALIST

Meet Ludovic BOCKEN (Lewis BEECH in English), a creative and visionary polymath researcher and developer who has been driven by the deep desire to innovate in our knowledge society for the last 25 years.

CONTACT DETAILS

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PERSONAL INFORMATION

Citizenship: **Canada - Belgium**
Languages:
English (professional),
French (native).

CORE SKILLS

- Python, R, JavaScript, C++, Perl, Prolog, Haskell
- VS Code, Posit ; GitHub, GitLab, Git ; Jupyter.
- SQL, SPARQL, Cypher,
- Shiny, Power BI
- pycaret, spaCy, nltk, OpenAI, LangChain
- networkx, Neo4J, Gephi, RDF, OWL, owlready2, Hermit, Protégé
- Azure, GCP, AWS, IBM
- Jira, Power Apps

HOBBIES

Drumming, Crafting, Triathlon.

EXPERIENCE

SENIOR CONSULTANT IN OPEN DATA, INNOVATION, AI & KNOWLEDGE ENGINEERING at *CGI for Hydro-Quebec (Montreal, CA)*. **2024.01–pres.**
◇ For Governance and Enterprise Architecture units, support compliance, analysis, design, development and LLMops of innovative (gen) AI projects.

CONSULTANCY, LEADERSHIP, INNOVATION, R&D in *Europe and North America (Brussels, BE - Montreal, CA)*. **1998.09–pres.**
◇ Recommend and develop metrics, methods, algorithms and solutions in gen AI, AI/ML, Text Analytics, Knowledge Engineering, Bio-mechanics.

SENIOR DATA SCIENCE LEAD at *SIA Innovation for Hydro-Quebec and with IBM - Build Labs (Montreal, CA)*. **2022.01–2023.01**
◇ Supported the implementation, optimization and development of machine learning and information retrieval applications with IBM products.

SENIOR ML ENGINEER at *Rocket Science Development for L'Oréal Canada with Amazon.ca data (Montreal, CA)*. **2021.03–2022.01**
◇ Applied and developed data science and machine learning algorithms to rank, classify and recommend products of L'Oréal Canada into Amazon.

DATA SCIENTIST at *Bell Canada with Scale AI, Canada's AI Cluster (Montreal, CA)*. **2021.02 – 2021.09**
◇ Optimized delivery predictive analytics applications developing algorithms in ML (regression) and text analytics (topic modeling, sentiment analysis).

RESEARCHER at *Quebec Research Funds (Montreal, CA)*. **2015–2018**
◇ 46.666 PhD scholarship - Developed algorithms, combinatorial metrics and models to control, classify and predict quality of Wikipedia articles.

LECTURER at *Academic Hub of Brussels (BE)*. **2008.09 – 2011.09**
◇ Managed e-learning platforms, supervised theses and taught communication, project management, computer science to thousands of students.

LECTURER at *University of Lille 1 Science & Technology (FR)*. **2010.07**
◇ Managed an e-Learning platform and applied educational data mining techniques to optimize learning and recommendations.

EDUCATION

PHD CANDIDATES IN NLP & COGNITIVE COMPUTING (AI) [GPA around 90%]. *UFC (FR) & Université du Québec (Montreal, CA)*. **2012–2019**
◇ Several Scholarships ; A+ : Logic, Computer Science and Cognitive Science ; Web Science & the Mind ; Information Management.

MASTER OF ARTS IN LANGUAGES AND LITERATURES [High Distinction]. *Université Libre de Bruxelles (Brussels, BE)*. **2008–2010**

TRAINING TO TEACH COMMUNICATION IN HIGHER EDUCATION. *Université Libre de Bruxelles (Brussels, BE)*. **2008**

MASTER OF ARTS IN LINGUISTICS [Distinction]. *Université Libre de Bruxelles (Brussels, BE)*. **2002–2006**

BACHELOR OF ARTS IN PHILOSOPHY [Distinction in the first year]. *Université Catholique de Louvain (Louvain-La-Neuve BE)*. **1999–2001**

CERTIFICATIONS (WORK IN PROGRESS)

MICROSOFT AZURE, GOOGLE CLOUD PLATFORM, AMAZON WEB SERVICES *Coursera*. **2024**
◇ Innovation, AI, ML, Data Science, Cloud Engineering, Management.

SOME RECOMMENDATIONS FROM LINKEDIN

Farid Bellameche, Director Consulting Delivery, AI Leader @ CGI : I have had the pleasure of collaborating with Ludovic on multiple occasions, particularly within the context of our monthly innovation meetings at CGI. His creativity and mastery of open brainstorming techniques have been instrumental in driving our discussions and sparking new ideas. Ludovic brings a unique perspective to every conversation, effortlessly combining rigor from his academic background and a leading force at Innovation Center at Hydro-Quebec with a practical, forward-thinking approach. His ability to facilitate engaging brainstorming sessions has consistently led to innovative solutions and a collaborative atmosphere. In our interactions, Ludovic has demonstrated exceptional skills in ideation and innovation. His enthusiasm and dedication to pushing boundaries are truly inspiring. I highly recommend Ludovic for any role that requires creativity, strategic thinking, and a passion for innovation.

André Gagnon, Strategist & Designer AI / Digital Transformation @ IBM : Ludovic is a brilliant data scientist who dwells equally well in the technical, the scientific approach as well as in the human understanding of the development of a complex implementation of an AI product. It was a pleasure to have met and collaborated with him on the conception and deployment of IBM Watson Discovery for field technician at Hydro-Quebec. His abilities to identify and deploy pertinent NLU and NLP methodology to harness tacit and implicit knowledge and make it available through the search engine and assure its relevancy is truly the value added. I had the chance to learn directly from an expert and participate in the crafting of a cutting-edge solution with his hands on and thoughtful approach. His wise and humorous approach makes it a charm to collaborate and exchange on a still occult discipline that is AI. I highly recommend him to help you define, architecture and deliver highly complex AI solutions and make sense of the data available and bring value to all your stakeholders.

Félix Frenette - AI Product Owner @ Hydro-Quebec : Ludovic's expertise has been essential in laying the foundations of our AI and ML solutions to develop best practices. Ludovic: intellect, skill & expertise in DS. First, Ludovic is brilliant and knowledgeable: he constantly keeps his expertise up-to-date. He is passionate about his subject and is naturally interested in current emerging concepts in DS. This attitude is game-changing. He imbibes a lot of novelties and scientific research in his field and reads a lot on the subject, which is constantly reflected in his daily work. His leadership in making the right decisions around data governance and for his clients to recommend appropriate solutions to projects is of crucial value. Ludovic was also able to convey his theoretical expertise pragmatically and concretely, and help us put these solutions in place. It was essential for us. He managed to manipulate big data and help build systems with the governance in place. He was able to derive great value from it, and his expertise in programming on more complex problems was recognized. He has a pedagogical approach to explaining complex technical concepts so that we can understand them well and visualize the vision to be put in place. Thank you for your precious help, I can only recommend you because it shows that you are well ... in your element!

Alexsandro Fonseca, PhD - Data Scientist @ Desjardins : Ludovic has a brilliant, curious and analytical mind. He is very able to understand complex problems and extract the deep meaning of concepts, structures and data. Combined with his incredible skills in NLP and ML, he is capable of bringing invaluable insights for any project he participates.

Jean-Guy Meunier, PhD, Professor of Text analytics and Cognitive computing @ UQAM : The expertise of Ludovic is at the cutting-edge of AI applied to information and knowledge database construction, management and recommendation. However, his personal and original signature is his high competence in the two main domains underlying this field : linguistics and computer science. He masters in a scholarly and practical manner the complexity of analyzing texts, of extracting their semantic and communicative content. On the other side, he is highly skilled for translating these tasks into many and most intelligent data mining and learning algorithms.

Cédrick Fairon, PhD, Full Professor at UCL, Faculty Dean, Director of CENTAL : I first met Ludovic when he was a student in Linguistics and he started to be interested in NLP. He took several of my courses and I remember him as a very dynamic and creative student, impassioned by language studies and quite energized by new technologies. He has a rich and original academic background that reveals his broad interest for human communication.

Marc-Henri De Bruyne, Founding Consultant @ WMH I had the pleasure and the frequent benefit to rub shoulders with Ludovic in the [Academic Hub of Brussels]. His passion for the imbroglio that is our brain and the wonders it produces has always impressed me. [...] Ludovic is a brilliant mind, sharp and as well able to 'crack' the complex code of a reasoning than simply explain the phenomenon.